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Postgraduate Program Guidelines

2024

Agriculture and Forestry University

Directorate of Postgraduate Program

Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

Postgraduate Committee

Vice Chancellor	Chairperson
Registrar	Member
Dean, Faculty of Agriculture	Member
Dean, Faculty of Animal Sci., Veterinary Sci. & Fisheries	Member
Dean, Faculty of Forestry	Member
Director, Research and Extension	Member
Controller, Examinations	Member
Director, Curriculum Development Center	Member
Director, Postgraduate Program	Member Secretary

Postgraduate (PG) Committee is the regulatory body of the PG program. The committee sets up the policy matters related to overall conduct modality of the PG programs. The policy matters set by the committee can be forwarded to the Academic Council and/or the Executive Council for final approval, as per the university rules and regulations. The PG committee also takes decision on matters put forward by the PG Program Director.

PhD Committee

Director, Postgraduate Program	Chairperson
Dean, related Faculty	Member
Director, Research and Extension	Member
Head, related Department	Member
Major advisor (after official assignment)	Member

The PhD committee evaluates the application for PhD admission and decides for admission offer, nominates major advisor and appoints member advisors based on the recommendation of major advisor, approves PhD candidacy, evaluates semester-wise progress of the PhD researchers and nominates the external examiners for final evaluation of PhD dissertation. Together with the external examiner and the advisory committee, the PhD committee also evaluates during the final defense seminar by the PhD candidate and recommends passing and qualifying the candidate for the PhD Degree award.

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Agriculture and Forestry University

Postgraduate Program

Agriculture and Forestry University (AFU) is the first technical university of Nepal that was established in 2010 by upgrading and merging the Institute of Agriculture and Animal Science (IAAS) at Rampur, Chitwan and Institute of Forestry at Hetauda, Makawanpur. Both the institutes were under Tribhuvan University. The AFU envisions becoming an eminent academic platform in agriculture and natural resource management contributing to advancing knowledge for transformative society through the pursuit of education, research and extension at the highest level of excellence. Post-graduate (PG) academic programs of Master of Science/Veterinary Science (M. Sc./M. V. Sc.) and Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) in different disciplines of agricultural, animal/veterinary and fisheries sciences were started at Rampur and of forestry science was started at Hetauda from 2013.

1. Postgraduate Academic programs

Faculty of Agriculture

a. Master of Science in Agriculture (M. Sc. Ag.) degrees
b. Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) degrees

Faculty of Forestry

a. Master of Science in Forestry (M. Sc. Forestry) degrees
b. Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) degrees

Faculty of Animal Science, Veterinary Science and Fisheries

a. Master of Veterinary Science (M. V. Sc.) degrees
b. Master of Science in Animal Science (M. Sc. An. Sc.) degrees
c. Master of Science in Fisheries (M. Sc. Fisheries) degrees
d. Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) degrees

2. Requirements and Eligibility for Admissions

M.Sc. Program:

M.Sc. Ag.

Applicant with a B.Sc. Ag., or equivalent degree

Minimum 16 (10+2+4) years of education

M. Sc. An. Sc.

Applicant with a B. Sc. Ag. or B. Sc. An. Sc., or B.V. Sc. & A. H. or equivalent degree

Minimum 16 years (10+2+4) of education

M.Sc. Fisheries

Applicant with a B.Sc. Fisheries, B.F.Sc., B.Sc. Ag., B.V.Sc. & A.H., M. Sc. Zoology (Fish and Fisheries) or equivalent degree

Minimum 16 years (10+2+4) of education

***M.V.*Sc**

Applicant with a B.V. Sc. & A. H. or equivalent degree

Minimum 17 years (10+2+5) of education

***M.Sc.* Forestry**

Applicant must have B. Sc. Forestry or equivalent degree

Minimum 16 years (10+2+4) of education

M. Sc. Forestry (Biodiversity) / M. Sc. Forestry (Environmental Science)

Applicant with a B. Sc. Forestry or B. Sc. Environmental Science or M. Sc Botany or M. Sc Zoology or B. Sc. Ag. or equivalent degree

Minimum 16 years (10+2+4) of education

PhD Program*:

Degree by Course and Research

An applicant must have M.Sc. degree in first division (division basis) or with CGPA 3.25/4.0 (CGPA basis) in the related/relevant field. However, prerequisite courses may be required for eligibility based on M.Sc. degree obtained.

The applicant must have published at least one research article in the refereed journal as a first author.

The applicant must have graduated from an institution where undergraduate and postgraduate teaching medium is English. However, in special cases standard language proficiency scores (IELTS/TOEFL/PTE) can be considered and reviewed by the committee.

The applicant must submit confidential letters of recommendation from two referees who would be in a position to judge academic and research capabilities of the applicant to undertake the PhD study successfully. At least one of the letters must be from academic mentor or a university professor of the relevant subject.

The applicant must submit an acceptable research proposal for PhD dissertation and must have assured research fund.

Degree by Research

An applicant must have a minimum of 5 years of working experience in academic, research or development after M. Sc. degree passed with second division (division basis) or CGPA 2.5/4.0 (CGPA basis) in the related/relevant field. However, prerequisite courses may be required for eligibility based on M. Sc. degree obtained.

The applicant having first division (division basis) or CGPA 3.25/4.0 (CGPA basis) must have published at least two research articles and candidate with second

division (division basis) or less than 3.25/4.0 CGPA (CGPA basis) must have published at least three research articles in the refereed journal as a first author.

The applicant must have graduated from an institution where undergraduate and postgraduate language of instruction and written examinations are in English. However, in special cases standard language proficiency scores (IELTS/TOEFL/PTE) can be considered and reviewed by the committee.

The applicant must submit confidential letters of recommendation from two referees who would be in a position to judge academic and research capabilities of the applicant to undertake the PhD study successfully. At least one of the letters must be from academic mentor or a university professor of the relevant subject.

The applicant must submit an acceptable research proposal for PhD dissertation and must have assured research fund.

*To pursue PhD studies in cross-cutting areas of Rural Sociology, Development Studies and Biotechnology, an applicant must have either of B. Sc. Ag. or B. Sc. Forestry or B. Sc. Fisheries or B. V. Sc. and A. H. or equivalent degrees and a master degree in the related/relevant field. Additionally, for PhD studies in Biotechnology, an applicant with B. Sc. Biotechnology and M. Sc. Biotechnology is also eligible.

PhD Candidacy

A PhD student after a successful defense of the research proposal and candidacy exam will then be a PhD Candidate/Scholar. PhD committee, in the presence of student's advisory committee, will conduct a standard candidacy exam either in written or oral along with proposal defense.

Student of degree by course and research category will complete proposal defense and candidacy exam by the 1st month of 3rd Semester. However in special cases, major advisor can allow the student to have candidacy registration in second semester and can recommend in written to the PhD committee for student's candidacy in second semester that can be conducted upon approval of the PhD committee.

Student of degree by research category will complete proposal defense and candidacy exam by the end of 1st Semester.

Candidates from different organizations and universities in Nepal

An applicant nominated officially by any governmental/non-governmental organization or university must meet all the minimum requirements and eligibility for admission, must submit the official nomination letter and must have a proof of financial support to undertake the studies. All non-nominated candidates holding a full time job must submit a letter of release from the working organization/university, must meet the admission requirements and must submit a proof of financial support to undertake the studies.

Candidates from other Countries

An applicant must meet the admission requirements stated above and must submit a proof of financial support to undertake PhD studies.

Residential requirements

All the students must meet the residential requirement of at least one and half years. However, PhD students under category of degree by research should get advice from the advisory committee regarding residential requirement.

3. Course and Research Requirements

M.Sc. Program (Total credit requirements)

Faculty / Program	Courses	Credit hours
1. Agriculture 2. Forestry 3. Animal Science 4. Veterinary Science* 5. Fisheries 6. Biotechnology	Major (Minimum)	15 18*
	Minor	5-10
	Supporting	5-11
	Seminar	1
	Thesis Proposal Thesis	 1 14
	Total (Minimum)	**45**

PhD by Course & Research (Total credit requirements)

Faculty / Program	Courses	Credit hr
1. Agriculture 2. Forestry 3. Animal Science 4. Veterinary Science 5. Fisheries 6. Biotechnology	Major (Minimum)	12
	Minor / Supporting	11
	Seminar	2
	Literature Review, Proposal & Candidacy	5
	Dissertation	30
	Total (Minimum)	**60**

PhD by Research (Total credit requirements)

Faculty / Program	Courses	Credit hr
1. Agriculture 2. Forestry 3. Animal Science 4. Veterinary Science 5. Fisheries 6. Biotechnology	Literature Review, Proposal & Candidacy	10
	Seminar (1/Semester)	5
	Dissertation	45
	Total	60

Types of Courses*:

Major courses

Major courses are the courses offered by the department or center in the field of study in which the student has enrolled.

Minor Courses

Minor course are the courses from other departments that are directly relevant to thesis research or dissertation that has to be approved by the advisory committee of the student.

*: If a Department or Center offers courses for different degrees, major courses and minor courses for different degrees should be specified with course codes.

Supporting courses:

Biochemistry, Statistics, Field Design, Survey Research Methodology, Advanced Plant/Animal Physiology and Scientific Writing and Communication.

Deficiency courses (For PhD)

PhD Committee at the time of admission offer will decide the total credit requirement for deficiency courses based on the deficit prerequisite courses or the schooling year required for admission. Major advisor in consultation with the department head will decide the courses to be offered as deficiency course.

Minimum and Maximum Credit Hours Limits

Course Semesters (M.Sc./PhD)

The unit of credit hours enrollment in 1st Semester: 9 - 12 credit and 2nd semester onwards: 9-16 credit hours.

Research Semesters

M Sc: 3rd Semester onwards (after proposal defense)

PhD with Course: 3rd Semester onwards (after candidacy)

PhD by Research: 2nd Semester onwards (after candidacy)

Note: A MSc and PhD with course student can be allowed to start their research after successful proposal defense in 2nd semester too with the recommendation of advisory committee and approval of faculty dean (for MSc) and PG Director (for PhD).

Attendance Requirement

Students pursuing courses in Masters and PhD degrees are required to fulfill the minimum attendance requirements of 75% to be eligible for the examinations and evaluation. The implementation of attendance compliance will be a collaborative effort between the Head of Department, Faculty Deans, PG Program Director and Examination Controller who will oversee its enforcement.

Duration for Degree

Normal Duration

Master degrees: 2 years (4 semesters)

PhD degrees: 3 years (6 semesters)

Maximum Allowable Duration

Master degrees cannot be extended beyond 4 years (8 semesters)

PhD degrees cannot be extended beyond 7 years (14 semesters)

Note: In order to extend their duration beyond the normal timeframe, students must provide a valid reason and supporting documents and recommendations from their major advisor which need to be approved by the respective faculty dean/PG director. Students should have fulfilled the minimum requirements for the degree and submit the thesis/dissertation draft for final evaluation within the given duration.

Requirements for PG Departments and Student intake capacity:

Requirements for PG Faculty

PhD degree,

Or

Associate professor or professor

Or

Assistant professor with M. Sc. degree and 3 years of teaching/research experiences and 2 journal articles in a peer reviewed journal (at least one as a first or corresponding author),

or

Faculty who has successfully supervised M Sc graduates as major advisor.

PG Department

Minimum three full-time PG faculty members are required to offer PG program in department.

One faculty member is allowed to teach one course in one semester.

One faculty member is allowed to guide maximum three thesis students at a time.

The department that runs the PhD program should have a Department chair who holds with a PhD degree or is a professor by position. Additionally, such department should have a minimum of 36 credit hour academic council approved courses for postgraduate (the Masters and PhD) program.

Student Enrollment Capacity

The department will only accept students as per its capacity.

The minimum number of students required to run the PG program in a department is three.

4. Thesis / Dissertation

Guidelines for M.Sc./M.V.Sc. Thesis:

1. The students are required to develop research proposal with the guidance of their major advisor. The research proposal must then be submitted to the advisory committee in respective department for review and approval. Once approved, the research proposal needs to be forwarded to the Faculty Dean and PG Office through Department head for record keeping and monitoring.
2. The students must have their research proposal approved either by the end of the 2nd Semester or within the 1st month of 3rd Semester.
3. The proposal defense week has been scheduled for the 1st month of 3rd Semester. For students defending proposal in 2nd semester, Department chair in consultation with advisory committee will decide the schedule. The proposal defense seminar will be conducted in the Department level and the record minute of the seminar with proposal acceptance should be submitted to the Dean Office by the Department chair that will be submitted to the Office of the Controller of Examinations by the Dean office.
4. Major advisor for a student pursuing M.Sc. studies will be assigned prior to the end of 1st Semester. The Department chair, in consultation with PG faculty and the student will recommend a potential Major advisor to Faculty Dean for approval. The allocation of a relevant PG faculty member as the major advisor will be based on their expertise as well as their teaching and research experiences. One major advisor can supervise maximum 3 students.
5. The major advisor in consultation with student will recommend maximum of two advisory committee members through the Department chair to the Faculty Dean for approval. Advisory committee member should have at least one year of experience in the relevant field after M. Sc. or its equivalent degree and published one journal article in a peer reviewed journal as a first or corresponding author.

6. Faculty Dean Office will send a list of major advisors, committee members and thesis research students to the PG Office for record keeping and monitoring.
7. Students are required to finish all the research work and produce a draft thesis in supervision and approval of advisory committee and must submit to the Office of the Faculty Dean by the end of class day of the 4th Semester.
8. Dean Office will publish the notice for submission of the thesis draft. Students should have full filled all the credit and other requirements and the thesis draft should have been duly approved by the advisory committee for submission to external evaluation.
9. An external examiner (minimum Assistant Professor or equivalent level with minimum five years of experience after obtaining Masters degree) with relevant expertise will be recommended by Department chair to the Faculty Dean who will decide and send to the external for evaluation of the thesis for each student.
10. External examiner is to evaluate the thesis critically as per template given to him/her and provide the result as **accepted for final defense** or **rejected** (with sufficient reason), and if accepted, with suggestion for its improvement. In case of thesis rejection, a second examination by second external will be done. If rejected by the second examiner as well, it will be returned to the advisory committee by the Dean Office. Advisory committee takes a final decision about the re-experimentation or improvement prior to resubmission that will follow the similar external evaluation process as earlier.
11. After acceptance of the thesis results by the external examiner, the student is required to go through successful pre-defense in the Department level in presence of the advisory committee and department faculties/students that will be coordinated by Department chair.
12. Thesis results accepted by external examiner and after its successful pre-defense in the department level will have to be defended by the student in the defense seminar.
13. Thesis defense week will be scheduled by the Dean Office as of examination week of the semester.
14. Thesis defense will be held at Faculty level and opened to faculties, students and others interested in the research. Junior batch Master level students of the Department, except under unavoidable or emergency situation with due approval of Head of the Department, should compulsorily attend the senior's thesis defense seminars.
15. The Faculty Dean will chair the thesis defense seminar. The Department chair will conduct the defense seminar in the presence of advisory committee (compulsory), external examiner (compulsory), research director and assistant dean (academics). PG Director will be the observer in the seminar.
16. Advisory committee and external examiner will separately evaluate the seminar presentation for its grading and forward it to the Department Chair for its final totaling and approval. Based on the average marks of evaluators, thesis will be graded as: Excellent (85% and above), Good (70 to less than 85%), and Satisfactory (50 to less than 70%).

17. Signed off thesis grade form will be forwarded to Faculty Dean on the same day after the defense seminar is over. Dean office will forward it to the PG office for record keeping and Examination Controller office for result publication process.
18. Students, in consultation and approval of the advisory committee, have to address/incorporate the comments, feedback and suggestions provided during external evaluation and defense seminar while preparing the final thesis.
19. Students should submit the final thesis duly signed off by the Major Advisor, Committee members, Department head and Faculty Dean together with the certificate for plagiarism test as per the University plagiarism testing guidelines within 15 days of the defense seminar.
20. If there is a change in the title of the thesis after its proposal defense, student should get an approval from the advisory committee chair and submit the approval letter together with the final thesis.
21. The final results of the thesis examination of the students who have submitted their duly signed off hard copies of theses will be published by the Controller of the Examinations.

Guidelines for PhD Dissertation:

1. The Major Advisor will be assigned by the PhD committee at the time of admission offer.
2. The Major Advisor must be Associate Professor or Professor of AFU with a PhD degree and have published 5 peer reviewed articles with a minimum of 3 as the first or the corresponding author. If the assistant professor of AFU with PhD degree has a continuous 5 years of teaching/research experience and full fills the above mentioned publication requirements, he/she is also eligible to be the major advisor for PhD student.
3. The major advisors will have the responsibility to provide guidance and supervision until the successful completion of student's PhD dissertation even after their retirement from the University. The major advisors have to provide a written request to the PG Director if they will be unable to continue as major advisor. PhD committee will foresee the request of the major advisor and assign a new major advisor in consultation with the member advisors and the student. In other special cases and requests of the advisors or student, PhD committee will take the decision.
4. The PhD committee will appoint two members of the advisory committee based on the recommendation of Major advisor. These members can be appointed from any departments or institutions within the country or abroad that is relevant to student's research.
5. The members of the Advisory Committee from AFU must be a PhD and have 3 research articles published in the peer reviewed journal as a first or corresponding author.

6. The non-teaching member from outside AFU must be a PhD with proven records of research experience and must have published at least 3 research articles in peer reviewed journals as a first or corresponding author.
7. PhD degree holding Faculties/Senior Scientists external to AFU with proven records of research experience and published at least 5 peer reviewed articles with a minimum of 3 as the first or the corresponding author may serve on the Advisory Committee as Co-advisor on the recommendation of the Major Advisor and approval of the PhD committee.
8. One major advisor can supervise maximum 3 PhD students. Advisory for up to 3 PhD students is allowed for one member advisor.

Dissertation Evaluation:

1. The student must conduct the research, produce required publication, prepare dissertation draft and present to the advisory committee for approval to its external evaluation.
2. PhD scholar (by research) must have published 3 peer reviewed journal articles, at least two in international Web of Science or Scopus indexed journals with JCR/Clarivate impact factor or SJR/Scimago rank and by course and research must have published at least one peer reviewed journal article in Web of Science or Scopus Indexed journals with JCR/Clarivate impact factor or SJR/Scimago rank. The student must get approval from the advisory committee prior to submitting the journal manuscript for publication. Scientists other than in the advisory committee can be co-authors in the journal article given his/her due contribution and with due approval from the advisory committee.
3. If the research articles are not published but have received letter of acceptance from the journal, student is eligible to submit the dissertation draft using the accepted article.
4. Postgraduate Office will publish the notice for submission of the dissertation draft. Students should have full filled all the credit and publication requirements and the dissertation draft should have been duly approved by the advisory committee for submission to the postgraduate office for external evaluation.
5. PhD Committee will select two external examiners (Professor or equivalent in position or by scientific contributions), at least one international expert from reputed university or research institutions outside the country and the other examiner can be from within the country but must be external to AFU.
6. The PG Director will correspond to the external examiners and send the PhD dissertation along with evaluation forms for the external evaluation of the dissertation. The externals will give the result to the PG Director as accepted (approved) along with comments/suggestion/questions for its improvement, or rejected (disapproved) with sufficient reasoning for rejection/disapproval.
7. The students must incorporate the comments/suggestion/questions of external examiners to their satisfaction. The student must submit both the clean and track changed e-copy of the dissertation as well as sequential responses in

tabulation form with due approval of the advisory committee to assess easily the amendments/answers.

8. If the dissertation is disapproved by one or both external examiners, a second opinion would be sought from a third (in the case of one disapproval) or third and fourth (in the case of both disapprovals) external examiners. If both the second-round examiners reject the dissertation, the student will be considered unsuccessful PhD candidate and will be automatically dropped from the PhD program. In the case of one acceptance and one rejection even in the second round evaluation, the PhD committee in consultation with advisory committee will decide whether to approve or reject the dissertation for the final defense.
9. Once the dissertation is accepted by the external examiners, the student must successfully complete an open pre-defense at the Department level in the compulsory presence of the advisory committee.
10. After receiving the pre-defense report, PhD Committee will decide about the final defense and the PG Office will arrange the final defense seminar which will consist of two sessions; an open or public session and a close or evaluation session.
11. The Postgraduate Program Director will chair the PhD defense seminar as the Chairperson of the PhD Committee.
12. There will be three-tier evaluation; Advisory Committee, externals and PhD Committee evaluations, of the dissertation research finding during evaluation session of the final defense seminar.
13. Upon evaluation of the student for successful defense by the Advisory Committee (compulsory physical presence), external examiners (in country examiner physical presence and out country examiner virtual presence as far as possible) and PhD committee (compulsory physical presence), student will be recommended for PhD degree award. In a special case that if a member advisor is out of the country, PhD committee can consider for his virtual presence during the defense seminar.
14. Students, in consultation and approval of the advisory committee, have to address/incorporate the comments, feedback and suggestions provided during external evaluation and defense seminar while preparing the final dissertation hard copy.
15. Students should submit, the final dissertation duly signed off by the Advisors, Faculty Dean and PG Director together with the certificate for plagiarism test as per the University plagiarism testing guidelines, within 21 days of the defense seminar.
16. If there is a change in the title of the thesis after its proposal defense, student should get recommendation from the advisory committee chair and submit the recommendation letter together with the final dissertation to the PG Office. PG Director will then approve it.
17. Upon submission of all documents and recommendations to the Office of the Controller of Examinations, an official result will be published by the Office of the Controller of Examinations.

5. Academic Session

Academic Year:

An Academic year consists two semesters.

Semester:

A semester is a time frame consisting of the beginning of classes until the completion of the final exams. In total, a semester lasts for 21 weeks, with the first 17 weeks dedicated to teaching and last 4 weeks designated for examinations.

Credit Unit (semester hours):

Each credit unit is comprised of at least 15 semester hours of instruction throughout the semester. This translates to one hour of theoretical class and two to three hours of practical work in either laboratories or field settings per week.

Academic Calendar:

Application and Entrance Exam

Application calls for M Sc and PhDs will be made two weeks before the Dashain–Tihar-Chhath festival holiday begins

Entrance exams will be conducted each year between Dashain and Tihar-Chhath

First Semester:

November – March (Kartik/Mangsir – Chaitra/Baishakh)

Note: New intake for both Masters and PhD will be once a year for the November semester.

1st Semester:

Course Registration and Class Start: November 1st to 3rd week (depending upon the festival holidays)

1st Internal Assessment: January 1st to 3rd week

2nd Internal Assessment: February 2nd to 4th week

End of Class: March 2nd to 3rd week

Final Exam: March last week to April 2nd week

Semester break: April 3rd to 4th week

Second Semester:

May - September (Baishakh/Jestha – Ashwin)

2nd Semester

Course Registration and Class Start: May 1st week

1st Internal Assessment: June 3rd week

2nd Internal Assessment: August 1st week

End of Class: September 1st to 2nd week

Final Exam: September 3rd to 4th week

Semester break: Dashain to Tihar-Chhath

There will be semester break after each Semester and the academic calendar developed each year at the time of admission will specify the dates. The academic calendar will be adjusted annually according to Dashain, Tihar, and Chhath holidays.

6. Student Categories based on the fee structure

Student Categories:

Competitive subsidized student

Competitive full pay student

Sponsored Nepalese student

Sponsored foreign student

Note: Fee structure will be decided by the faculty Dean (for Masters level) and PG Director (for PhD level) as per the University rule.

7. Grading System

Grade:

A = Excellent
B = Good
C = Satisfactory
D = poor (Fail)
I = Incomplete

Grade Point:

A = 4 point
B = 3 point
C = 2 point
D = 1 point
I = no grade

Grade Allocation:

A = 85% and above
B = 70 to less than 85%
C = 50 to less than 70%
D = Less than 50%, which should be improved to higher grades

I = Incomplete of the courses/thesis which is replaced by other grade upon the completion of the course or thesis

Credit seminar of PhD candidate will be graded as satisfactory /unsatisfactory, and major advisor will serve as seminar in-charge.

Requirement for degree:

Students should pass clear all the subjects and all other requirements prior to submitting the thesis/dissertation draft.

Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) should be 2.5 for Master.

If he/she has less than the passing CGPA, the student would disqualify to get the degree.

However, he/she can reappear in any subjects of his/her choice till he/she attains the minimum required CGPA to get the degree.

No division will be allotted in PhD degree. However, transcript of course work with grade will be provided and should have 3.0 passing CGPA.

Transcript with Dissertation topic with satisfactory grade will be provided upon the completion of the degree.

CGPA: M.Sc. Level

3.75 and above:	Distinction
3.25 and above:	First division
2.5 and above:	Second division

8. Credit Transfer and Enrollment

Credit Transfer System and Enrollment:

M.Sc. /PhD students enrolled at other university may apply to AFU for enrollment with his/her completed credit credentials.

AFU may accept those students with credit transfer based on AFU's credit requirements and regulations. The faculty dean for MSc student and PhD Committee for PhD student will take the decision.

Such students should pay admission fee and registration fee as required.

Cross credit courses (Only for PhD program)

PhD committee may decide cross credit courses for credit transfer based on the demand of the student and recommendation of the Major Advisor. This will imply only to the Masters graduate from the AFU and only for supporting courses (if repetition of the courses take place) not exceeding 6 credit hours or 2 courses, not for major courses. Students should compulsorily make the course registration and pay tuition fee for such courses.

9. Degree Award

PG Degree Award

For Masters level degrees, the dean office maintains the students records from admission to the recommendation for the degree and will check whether students have completed all the requirements for degree and then recommend for degree award. The records in the PG office will be for cross checking, if needed.

For PhD degrees, PG office maintains the students records from admission to the recommendation for the degree and will check whether students have completed all the requirements for degree. After the successful final defense of the dissertation research results, the PhD committee and the advisory committee jointly recommend for PhD degree award.

10. PG program monitoring

Roster of PG Faculty will be maintained at Faculty Dean Office and PG Office.

Courses offered with course instructor's list will be sent to Faculty Dean and PG Office for record through Department head.

A monitoring and evaluation committee headed by PG Director and approved by the University Vice Chancellor will monitor PG classes and researches to maintain and cross check quality between different faculties.

By the end of the semester each course with instructor will be evaluated by students.

Outcome of the evaluation will be shared within the PG Committee.

PG Committee will have necessary action on the outcome.

Any disputes between students and faculties in courses and research will also be addressed by the committee.

A discussion with course instructors and faculty Deans will be organized at the end of the semester focusing to grade distribution, internal evaluation and course content covered.

The outcome of the discussion would be shared in the PG Committee for necessary action.

FORMS (M.Sc./M.V.Sc.) AND GUIDELINES

Receipt No…….. Applicant's Regd. No……

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

PP Sized Recent Photo (3 copies, name written underside)

Master of Science/Veterinary Science (MSc/MVSc)

ADMISSION APPLICATION FORM

A. FACULTY (Field of Study):

Faculty of Agriculture:

Department/ Field of Study pursuing admission ……

Faculty of Animal Science, Veterinary Science and Fisheries:

Department/ Field of Study pursuing admission ……

Faculty of Forestry:

Department/ Field of Study pursuing admission ……

B. APPLICANT'S DETAILS:

1. Full Name (in BLOCK Letters): ….……..……

(First name) (Middle name) (Last name/ Surname)

2. Date of Birth: ……/…..…..…/…..…… (B.S.) ……/……../…… (A.D.)

Day Month Year Day Month Year

3. Place of Birth: ……..……..……

4. Nationality: ……..….. **5. Marital Status:** Unmarried/ Married

6. Sex: Male / Female/Others

7. Present Occupation/Position (if any): ……..……

8. Employer and Address (if any): ……..……

9. Guardian's Full Name: ……..……..……..……

10. Relation to Guardian: ……

11. Guardian's Occupation: …..……..……..……

12. Permanent Address: Country:……. Province:…….District: ……..…

Village Council /Municipality/Sub-Metro/Metropoliton:…….……Ward #:.....Village/Tole: ……..……

Street:…….. House #.....Tel.:……...…Fax: ……

13. Mailing Address: ……...…….……

PO Box #.....Tel.:…… Fax: ……

Mobile:…….. E-mail: …….…….....…

C. ACADEMIC BACKGROUND:

Academic Records	Degrees	Board/ University & Country	Passed Year	Percentage / Grade	Major Subjects	Remarks
Bachelor's Level						
Master's Level						
Others:						

(Attach additional sheet, if required)

D. PROFESSIONAL TRAINING RECORDS:

Year	Duration/Date	Country	Subject

(Attach additional sheet, if required)

F. PROFESSIONAL / WORK EXPERIENCES:

Duration	Designation	Organization

(Attach additional sheet, if required)

G. AWARDS/MEDALS/SCHOLARSHIPS RECEIVED:

Year	Name of Award/Medals/Scholarship	Organization	Field of Contribution

(Attach additional sheet, if required)

H. ACADEMIC / EMPLOYEE REFEREES:

Name	Designation	Contact Address (including Tel./Mobile & E-mail)

(Attach additional sheet, if required)

ENCLOSURE DOCUMENTS CHECK LIST	DECLARATION / CERTIFICATION:
Submit the OFFICIAL COPY (attested copy) of followings, in order as: 1. Citizenship/Passport 2. Complete academic certificates and transcripts (from bachelor degree) 3. Grade conversion certificate (if marks are mentioned in GRADE basis) 4. Official nomination letter (for nominee) 5. Official release letter (for self-financing student) 6. Recommendation letter (1) 7. Letter of sponsorship (funded by sponsoring agencies) 8. Application fee paid receipt (from account section of AFU 9. Others (if any): ……..	The information given above is true to best of my knowledge and I shall take sole responsibility on any false statements. I apply for the admission under post graduate program of AFU and will abide all the rules, regulations and future amendments of AFU. *Applicant's Signature.* : ……. Date*:* **……**

(For Official Use Only)

Application Receipt No.: …….. Regd. No.: ……. Checked by ……

Verified by …….. ……..….. Date: ……

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

Course Registration Form
(Date: ……..)

Name of Student _____ Registration # _____

Faculty, Department & Field of Study_____ Semester _____

Year _____

M.Sc./M.V.Sc. ( ) PhD ( ) PhD by Research ( )

Course Code	Course Title	Credit Hours	Course In-charge Signature

_____	_____	_____	_____
Student	Department Head	Account Section	Faculty Dean
Date	Date	Date	Date

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

Recommendation/Approval Form for Major Advisor

(Date: …….)

Degree: MSc / M.V.Sc.

Faculty:

Department:

Roll #	Name of Student	Field of Interest	Proposed Major Advisor	Signature of Advisor
1.				
2.				
3.				
4.				
5.				
6.				
7.				
8.				
9.				
10.				
11.				

Recommendation:

Department Head (Signature & date): _____

Approved:

Faculty Dean (Signature & date): _____

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

Approval of M. Sc. / M. V. Sc. Student's Advisory Committee

(Date: …….)

1. Name of Student: _____
2. I.D. No.: _____
3. Date of Enrollment: _____
4. Department: _____
5. Faculty: _____

Composition of Advisory Committee

Advisory committee	Name and Designation	Affiliated Institution	Signature
Chair-person Member Member			

<u>Recommendation:</u>

Advisory Committee Chair (Signature & date): _____

Department Head (Signature & date): _____

<u>Approved:</u>

Faculty Dean (Signature & date): _____

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

M. Sc. Seminar Evaluation Form

(Date: …….)

Name of Student: _____

I.D. No.: _____ Semester: _____

Faculty: _____ Department: _____

Course code: _____ Credit hr: 0+1

Seminar Title:_____

_____

Marks Summary

Examiner	Full Marks	Marks Obtained	Remarks
External	25		
Internal (Advisory Committee Chair)	25		
Total	**50**		

Grade: _____

(Excellent: 85 and above; Good: 70 to below 85; Satisfactory: 50 to below 70)

External Examiner (Name and signature): _____

Advisory Committee Chair (Name and signature): _____

Department Head (Name and signature): _____

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

M.sc./M.V.Sc. Thesis Approval Form
(Advisory Committee)

Name of Student:
I.D. No.:
Department/Faculty:

Thesis Title:
_____

_____

I, the undersigned Advisory Committee Chair / Member, have duly examined the above mentioned Thesis Draft and duly approve the draft for its external evaluation and final defense.

Name	Advisory Committee Chair / Member	Signature and date

Note:
It is compulsory for the students to submit this approval form while submitting the thesis draft for its external evaluation, in case the Advisory Committee Chair / Member is unable to put his/her original signature in the draft.

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

Masters Thesis External Evaluation Form

Part A:

External examiner's name, signature and date (use official stamp, if available)	
External examiner's e mail address / phone number	
External examiner's address (affiliation)	
Student's registration/roll number	
Evaluated thesis title	

Part B:

Recommendation (Accepted for final defense/Rejected):
…….

Note: In case of rejection, please mention the sufficient ground (Please use additional sheet, if needed).

Part C: Comments/suggestions for improvement

1. **Major comments (Please use additional sheet, if needed)**
   a)
   b)
   c)

2. Minor comments (Please use additional sheet, if needed)
   a)
   b)
   c)

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

M.Sc. Thesis Evaluation Form (Advisory Committee)

(Date: …….)

Name of Student: _____

I.D. No.:_____ Semester:_____

Faculty:_____ Department: _____

Course code:_____ Credit hr: **15**

Thesis Title: _____

_____

Evaluation Criteria

Descriptions	Full Marks	Marks Obtained	Remarks
Rational and Objectives	5		
Literature Review	10		
Methodology / Materials and Methods	10		
Results and Discussion	10		
Conclusion and Recommendations	5		
Presentation	5		
Response to Questions	5		
Total	**50**		

<u>Evaluated by :</u>

Advisory Committee:

Chair / Member **(Name and signature):** _____

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

M.Sc. Thesis Evaluation Form (External Examiner)

(Date: …….)

Name of Student: _____

I.D. No.:_____ Semester:_____

Faculty:_____ Department: _____

Course code:_____ Credit hr: **15**

Thesis Title: _____

_____

Evaluation Criteria

Descriptions	Full Marks	Marks Obtained	Remarks
Rational and Objectives	5		
Literature Review	10		
Methodology / Materials and Methods	10		
Results and Discussion	10		
Conclusion and Recommendations	5		
Presentation	5		
Response to Questions	5		
Total	**50**		

External Examiner (Name and signature): _____

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

M.Sc. Thesis Evaluation Grade

(Date: …….)

Name of Student: _____

I.D. No.:_____ Semester:_____

Faculty:_____ Department: _____

Course code:_____ Credit hr: **15**

Thesis Title: _____

_____

Marks Summary

Evaluator	Full Marks	Marks Obtained	Remarks
Advisory Committee: Chair Member Member	 50 50 50		
Average	50		
External Examiner	50		
Total	**100**		

Grade: _____

(Excellent: 85 and above; Good: 70 to below 85; Satisfactory: 50 to below 70)

Advisory Committee Chair (Name and signature):_____

External Examiner (Name and signature): _____

Department Head (Name and signature): _____

FORMS (PhD) AND GUIDELINES

Applicant's Regd. No…….

Receipt No……

Agriculture and Forestry University

Directorate of Postgraduate Program

Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

Doctor of Philosophy (PhD)

ADMISSION APPLICATION FORM

A. FACULTY (Field of Study):

Faculty of Agriculture:

Department/Field of Study **……** …….

Faculty of Animal Science, Veterinary Science and Fisheries:

Department/Field of Study …….

Faculty of Forestry:

Department/ Field of Study ……..

Degree: By Course and Research ( ) By Research ( )

B. APPLICANT'S DETAILS:

1. Full Name (in BLOCK Letters):

…..……..……

(First name) (Middle name)

(Surname)

2. **Date of Birth:** ……/……/…… (B.S.) ……/……../…… (A.D.)

Day Month Year Day Month Year

3. **Place of Birth**: ……...……..……**Citizenship Number**……

4. **Nationality**: ……..……

5. **Marital Status**: Unmarried/ Married

6. **Sex**: Male / Female

7. **Present Occupation/Position** (if any):

……..……

8. **Employer and Address** (if any):

……..……

9. **Guardian's Full Name**: ……..……..……

10. Relation to Guardian: ……

11. Guardian's Occupation: …..……..……

12. **Permanent Address**: Country: ……. Province; ……. District: ……..

VDC/Municipality/Sub-Metro/Metro: …… Ward #: ..... Village/Tole: ……

Street: …….. House #. ..... Tel.: ……..…Fax: ……

13. **Mailing Address**: ……

PO Box #.....Tel.: …… Fax: ……..

Mobile: …….. E-mail: ……..……..…

C. ACADEMIC BACKGROUND:

Academic Records	Degree	Board/University & Country	Passed Year	Percentage/ Grade	Major Subjects	R
Bachelor's Level						
Master's Level						
Others:						

(Attach additional sheet, if required)

D. PROFESSIONAL TRAININGS

Year	Duration/Date	Country	Subject

(Attach additional sheet, if required)

E. PUBLICATIONS:

1.

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……..

(Attach additional sheet, if required)

F. PROFESSIONAL / WORK EXPERIENCES:

Duration	Designation	Organization

(Attach additional sheet, if required)

G. AWARDS/MEDALS/SCHOLARSHIP RECEIVED:

Year	Name of Award/Medals/Scholarship	Organization	Field of Contribution

(Attach additional sheet, if required)

H. ACADEMIC / EMPLOYEE REFEREES:

Name of the referee	**Designation**	**Contact Address** (including Tel./Mobile & E-mail)

(Attach additional sheet, if required)

I. PROPOSED TITLE OF STUDY:

Title:

……

……

(Attach Concept Note of proposed study

ENCLOSURE DOCUMENTS CHECK LIST

Submit the OFFICIAL COPY (attested copy) of followings, in order as:

1. Curriculum Vitae
2. Citizenship/Passport
3. Complete academic certificates and transcripts (from bachelor degree)
4. Grade conversion certificate (if marks are mentioned in GRADE basis)
5. Official nomination letter (for nominee)
5. Official release letter (for self-financing student)
6. Recommendation letters (2, one from University Professor)
7. Work experience letter/s
8. Concept note of proposed study
9. Letter of sponsorship (funded by sponsoring agencies)
10. Publications as first author (Hardcopy)
11. Application fee paid receipt (from account section of DPGP, AFU)
12. Others (if any)……..

DECLARATION / CERTIFICATION:

The information given above is true to best of my knowledge and I shall take sole responsibility on any false statements. I apply for the admission under post graduate program of AFU and will abide all the rules, regulations, and future amendments of AFU.

Applicant's Signature. : …….

(For Official Use Only)

Application Receipt No.: …..…….. Regd. No.: ……

Checked by …….

Verified by ……... ……..….. Date: …….

- *Kindly print or make a hard copy, duly fill it out and submit to the Directorate of Post Graduate Program, Agriculture and Forestry University, Rampur, Chitwan.*

Post Graduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

Mark sheet of Internal Assessment Examination

Date:……

Level: …… **Academic Year: ……** **Full Marks:**……

Course Code:…… **Course Title:**…… **Credit Hour:**…….

Roll No.	Name of the Students	Marks obtain in							Remarks
		1st term		2nd term		Total Marks		Grand Total	
		Quiz	Practical	Quiz	Practical	Quiz	Practical		
Grand Total in Words.....									

Name of Course In charge:……

Signature:……

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

Approval of PhD Student's Advisory Committee

(Date: …….)

1. Name of Student: _____
2. I.D. No.: _____
3. Date of Enrollment: _____
4. Category of student: Self? / Nominee / Others (Can we be specific?)
5. Degree program: PhD by Course and Research / PhD by Research
6. Department: _____
7. Major Field: _____
8. Proposed Research Title: _____

Composition of Advisory Committee

Advisory committee	Name and Designation	Affiliated Institution	Signature
Chair-person Co-Chair person* Member Member			

*Not mandatory

<u>Recommendation:</u>

Chairperson (Signature & date): _____

Department Head (Signature & date): _____

<u>Approval:</u>

Faculty Dean (Signature & date): _____

PG Director (Signature & date): _____

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

Proposal Defend and Candidacy

(Date: …….)

Semester: …….

1. Name of Student: _____
2. I.D. No.: _____
3. Date of Enrollment: _____
4. Category of student: General / Nominee / Others
5. Degree program: PhD by Course and Research / PhD by Research
6. Department: _____
7. Major Field: _____
8. Proposed Research Title: _____

Recommendation from Advisory Committee

Advisory committee	Name	Recommended for PhD Candidate		Signature and date
		Yes	No	
Chairperson Member Member				

<u>Recommendation:</u>

Chairperson (Signature & date): _____

Department Head (Signature & date): _____

<u>Approval:</u>

Faculty Dean (Signature & date): _____

PG Director (Signature & date): _____

Postgraduate Program

Agriculture and Forestry University

Rampur, Chitwan

PhD Research Proposal Format

Research proposal should be prepared in consultation with the advisory committee, defend it as a pre-requisite for PhD candidacy and submit the approved proposal to the Directorate of Post Graduate Program of the University. Following major components should be included in the proposal that should be written consistently by using APA format (7th edition) of referencing, limiting to 15-20 pages. The sequence of the sections can be altered to suit the discipline and the research methodology being applied.

1. Title page: Title followed by the candidate's name, ID, email, and advisory committee names, position and affiliation including e-mail address.

2. Introduction: Showing the pertinent background information, problem statement or research question, rationale and justification, and objective as well as theoretical/conceptual framework indicating the hypothesis or the research questions (if needed).

3. Literature review: Covering research gaps with pertinent review of the related literatures.

4. Materials and methods/methodology (for social science): Showing detail of study design, methods, tools and data analysis.

5. Expected results, outputs, and or publications scheme.

6. Limitations of the research.

7. Time frame

8. Literature cited

Postgraduate Program

Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

PhD Candidate Progress Evaluation

(Date: …….)

1. Name of Student: Semester:
2. I.D. No.:
3. Date of Enrollment:
4. Category of student: General / Nominee ( ) / Others
5. Degree program: PhD by Course and Research ( ) / PhD by Research ( )
6. Department:
7. Major Field:
8. Research Title:

Recommendation from Advisory Committee

Advisory committee	Name	Recommended for Continue		Signature and date
		Yes	No	
Chairperson Co-Chair person Member Member				

<u>Recommendation:</u>

Chairperson (Signature & date): _____

Department Head (Signature & date): _____

<u>Approval:</u>

Faculty Dean (Signature & date): _____

PG Director (Signature & date): _____

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

PhD Candidate Seminar Evaluation Form

(Date: …….)

Semester:……

1. Name of Student: _____
2. I.D. No.: _____
3. Date of Enrollment: _____
4. Category of student: General / Nominee / Others
5. Degree program: PhD by Course and Research / PhD by Research
6. Department: _____
7. Major Field: _____
8. Seminar Title: _____

Evaluation be Seminar In-charge/Chairperson of Advisory Committee:

Satisfactory: Yes ☐ No ☐

Recommendation:

Chairperson (Signature & date): _____

Department Head (Signature & date): _____

Approval:

Faculty Dean (Signature & date): _____

PG Director (Signature & date): _____

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

PhD Student/Candidate Progress Report

(Date: …….)

1. Name of Student: _____
2 I.D. No.: _____
3 Date of Enrollment: _____
4 Category of student: General / Nominee ( ) / Others
5 Degree program: PhD by Course and Research ( ) / PhD by Research ( )
6 Department: _____
7 Research Title: _____

Current semester (I/II/III/IV/V/VI):

To be filled by PhD student/candidate (use additional page if required)

S.N.	Description of work performed (Courses/ Candidacy / Seminar / Research part)

_____
Signature of student/candidate

Approval:
Chairperson, Advisory Committee (Signature & date): _____
Department Head (Signature & date): _____
Faculty Dean (Signature & date): _____
PG Director (Signature & date): _____

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

Student Attendance Sheet

Level:
Faculty: Date:
Department: Semester:
Subject:
Exam:

S.N.	Roll No	Name of the Students	Signature	Remarks

Name and Signature ……
(Major Advisor/External Examiner)

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

Semester Extension Form
(Date: …….)

Name of Student : _____

Student ID. No.: _____

Faculty : _____

Department : _____

Level : _____

Semester extension to ……..semester

Reason _____

_____

_____

Student (Signature and date) _____

Approved by
Advisory Committee Chair (Signature and date) _____

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

Declaration of the Publication
(Date: …….)

On behalf of the advisory committee, I approve that the following paper/s submitted herewith by…….(ID No:……) as the requirement of PhD degree is/ are the peer reviewed journal article/s categories as follows.

S.N.	Tittle of the article	Journal	Category (National/international)	Indexing/Rank*

*Indexing/Rank: Web of Science or Scopus indexed with JCR/Clarivate impact factor or SJR/Scimago rank for international category journals. All non-ranked journals should be mentioned as national category.

Name, signature and date
Chair of the Advisory Committee

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

PhD Dissertation Approval Form
(Advisory Committee)

Name of Student:
I.D. No.:
Department/Faculty:

Thesis Title:
_____

_____

I, the undersigned Advisory Committee Chair / Member, have duly examined the above mentioned Dissertation Draft and duly approve the draft for its external evaluation and final defense.

Name	Advisory Committee Chair / Member	Signature and date

Note:
It is compulsory for the students to submit this approval form while submitting the thesis draft for its external evaluation, in case the Advisory Committee Chair / Member is unable to put his/her original signature in the draft.

Postgraduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University
Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal

PhD Dissertation External Evaluation Form

Part A:

External examiner's name, signature and date (use official stamp, if available)	
External examiner's e mail address/contact number	
External examiner's address (Affiliation)	
Country	
PhD candidate's registration number	
Evaluated dissertation title	

Part B: Evaluation result

Recommendation (Accepted for final defense/rejected):

Note: In case of rejection, please mention the sufficient ground (Please use additional sheet, if needed).

Part C: Major comments/inputs (Please use additional sheet, if needed)

a)

b)

Part D: Minor comments/inputs (Please use additional sheet, if needed)

a)

b)

Part D: Questions to the candidate (Please use additional sheet, if needed)

Please submit your pertinent questions to the candidate to be asked during the dissertation defense examination.

a)

b)

Postgraduate Program

Agriculture and Forestry University

Rampur, Chitwan

GUIDELINES FOR SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS (MSc, MVSc and PhD)

1. Students should prepare power point presentation (ppt) using a plain white background, Times New Roman font with appropriate size (minimum size: 36 with first word capital for the main title, 32 with first word capital for slide head/headings, 28 for subtitles and 24 for text).
2. Animations are not allowed to be used, however, highlighting using different color fonts, shapes etc can be done.
3. Presentation materials should be clear, concise, free of errors and should have been approved by advisory committee. Students should take care of the given time limit while preparing and delivering the presentation.
4. The first slide should contain the title and the student's name, ID, degree name and complete affiliation.
5. The second slide should contain the advisory committee (Chair followed by members) with name, highest degree, position and complete affiliation.
6. The third slide should contain outline of presentation. In proposal defense, it should contain introduction (that includes in subheadings background, statement of problem/research question, rationale of the study and objective), materials and methods/methodology with conceptual framework (for social science), expected results or output including publication plan (PhD), research limitations, research plan/time table/Gantt chart and literature cited. In progress seminar (PhD), it should contain research objective, current semester progress/results and next semester plan. In final defense seminar, students should strictly follow the university thesis/dissertation guidelines for the major headings in outline of presentation and the subsequent slides except results and discussion goes together in defense seminar.
7. The full or the partial financial/grant support (if any), material or logistic support, support for collecting and analyzing data, laboratory support and/or any other support to carry out the research should be duly acknowledged during final defense seminar. Acknowledgement slide in presentation should be placed after recommendations for further research.

GUIDELINES FOR THESIS/DISSERTATION PREPARATION

1. Language

English

2. Paper Specifications

Color : White

Size : 21 cm x 29.7 cm (A4)

Weight : 80 g m^{-2}

3. Typing

Left margin :	3.5 cm
Right margin :	2.0 cm
Top margin :	3.0 cm
Bottom margin :	2.5 cm
Spacing :	1.5 lines
Side :	Front single
Font size :	12 (size 10 is smaller than 12)
Font type :	Times New Roman
Font style :	Regular
Font color :	Black
Corrections with fluid :	Not allowed
Overwriting :	Not allowed
Crossing out words :	Not allowed
Typing machine :	Computer
Printing quality :	Laser or letter quality
Copies :	High quality photocopy

4. Illustrations and Photographs

- Place within thesis/dissertation text at appropriate places
- Paste the photographs or illustration plates which are printed on special papers
- Type titles at the bottom of the illustration in the font used in the text

5. **Top Cover** (A sample is given in Appendix A)

Typed in all capital letters, should include

- Approved thesis/dissertation title typed 7.5 cm below the top margin
- Full name of the author typed in the middle of the page
- Year of thesis/dissertation submission typed 5 cm above the bottom margin

The left binding width should contain

- Name of the degree, e.g., M.Sc./Ph.D
- Short name of the author followed by a dash mark and year of submission e.g., K.N. Shrestha-2015

6. **Title Page** (A sample is given in Appendix B)

Title length commonly not longer than 15 words.

It is the first page under the top cover typed in all capital letters and center justified on each line with the following information.

- Approved thesis title 5 cm below the top of the page
- Full name of the author typed 8 lines below the title
- The following contents typed 8 lines below the title:

THESIS / DISSERTATION
SUBMITTED TO THE
AGRICULTURE AND FORESTRY UNIVERSITY
FACULTY OF ……
…….(ADDRESS)…….
NEPAL

- Further 3 lines below the following should be typed:

IN PARTIAL FULFILMENT OF THE
REQUIREMENTS FOR THE
DEGREE OF

- Further 3 line below the following should be typed:

(name of the degree)
(major subject within parentheses)

- Month and year of final copy of thesis/dissertation submission should be given at the bottom line

7. Certificates

Each thesis/dissertation submitted for evaluation will have two certificates

- Certificate from the Chairman of the Advisory Committee (Appendix C)
- Certificate from the Advisory Committee (Appendix D)

8. Acknowledgement

- A short acknowledgement sheet should be next to the title sheet
- It should acknowledge contributions of all concerned, including financial sponsors, if any.

9. Table of Contents

Should include the chapter headings and also the subtitles, if any, with appropriate page references.

Should be placed next to the certificate sheets.

The text of the thesis/dissertation should usually consist of the following chapters:

Model 1: For Masters/PhD level

- Introduction [i) Background, ii) Statement of Problem/Research Question, iii) Rationale of the Study, iv) Objective]
- Literature Review [specifically justifying the research question and objectives]
- Materials and Methods/Methodology (for Social Science) [showing details of study design, methods, tools and data analysis]
- Results [following the sequence of the study/experiment]
- Discussion [analyzing critically, interpreting and justifying the scientific merit and novelty of the research findings, including the implications and limitations of the study]
- Conclusion [summarizing the research findings that gives answer to the research questions and objective]
- Recommendation for further Research [addressing research limitations and exploring further science of the research findings]
- Literature Cited [using APA 7th edition model]
- Appendices [including list of publications, questionnaire and so on that are useful information/materials but not included in the main text]
- Biographical Sketch (showing academic journey of the student)

Model 2: For PhD level

- Chapter 1: General Introduction [i) Background Information, ii) Statement of Problem/Research Question, iii) Rationale of Study, iv) Objective]
- Chapters 2, 3, 4 etc: Chapters with specific headings based on published/ unpublished research works [showing introduction, materials and methods/methodology (for Social Science), results, discussion leading to specific conclusion]
- Chapter (subsequent): General Discussion [reflecting scientific merit and novelty of the research findings, including the implications and limitations of the study]
- Chapter (subsequent): General Conclusion [showing the finding that gives answer to the main research question]
- Chapter (subsequent): Recommendation for Further Research [addressing research limitations and exploring further science of the research findings]
- Literature Cited [using APA 7th edition model]
- Appendices [including list of publications, questionnaire and so on that are useful information/materials but not included in the main text]
- Biographical Sketch (showing academic journey of the student)

Note: PhD student in consultation with advisory committee will use the appropriate model for his/her dissertation.

10. Literature Cited

A sample is given in Appendix E

11. Submission of Thesis/Dissertation

Thesis/dissertation can be submitted during office hours on any day of the semester a student is registered for. Failing to do so will require the student to register and pay all fees for another semester.

Four unbounded copies of the thesis should be submitted to the respective faculty Dean/Director.

12. Abstract (1 to maximum 2 pages, A sample format is given in Appendix F)

13. Final Submission of Thesis/Dissertation

The final copy of the thesis/dissertation must contain the following information in the order given below.

1. Cover Page (hard bound)
2. Title Page

3. Certificate (Appendix C)
4. Thesis/Dissertation Acceptance Form (Appendix – I/J)
5. Acknowledgement
6. Table of Contents
7. List of Tables
8. List of Figures (if any)
9. List of Appendices (if any)
10. Abstract in English (one to maximum two pages or 300 to 500 words. The abstract should begin with a brief but precise statement of the problem or issue and research objective, followed by a description of the research method and design, the major findings, and the conclusion)
11. Abstract in Nepali (one page simple summary with take home message in simple Nepali language)
12. Text of the thesis
13. Biographical Sketch (a brief academic journey)

No page number should be shown on the title page and thesis acceptance form but it should be counted.

Page numbering should start from acknowledgement in Greek numerals with acknowledgement page numbered 'iii' at the bottom in the middle. Greek numbering this way should continue till abstract page. Arabic numerals should start from the page containing Introduction near the upper right corner of the page. The pages containing individual chapter titles such as Introduction, Literature Review, Materials and Methods, etc., should be counted but should not be numbered.

Both MS thesis and PhD dissertation should be bound in dark green hard cover with golden letters.

Corrections and modifications suggested during Thesis/Dissertation evaluation must be properly incorporated.

Two hard bound copies should be submitted to the respective faculty Dean after successful completion of the examination.

APPENDIX - A

(Sample of the Top Cover)

PRODUCTIVE PERFORMANCE OF BLUE PANIC (*Panicum antisdotale*) UNDER STRESS CONDITION

BHARAT SAH

DECEMBER 2016

APPENDIX - B

(Sample of the Title Page)

PRODUCTIVE PERFORMANCE OF BLUE PANIC (*Panicum antisdotale*) UNDER STRESS CONDITION

BHARAT SAH

THESIS / DISSERTATION

SUBMITTED TO THE

AGRICULTURE AND FORESTRY UNIVERSITY

FACULTY OF ……

……..……..(ADDRESS)…….

NEPAL

IN PARTIAL FULFILMENT OF THE

REQUIREMENTS FOR THE

DEGREE OF

MASTER OF SCIENCE IN AGRICULTURE / DOCTOR OF PHILOSOPHY

(AGRONOMY)

DECEMBER 2016

APPENDIX - C

(Format of the Certificate)

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the thesis/dissertation entitled "_____" submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of _____ (_____) of the Agriculture and Forestry University, Nepal is a record of original research carried out by Mr./Ms. _____ Id. No. _____, under my supervision, and no part of the thesis/dissertation has been submitted for any other degree or diploma.

_____

(Name)

Chairperson of the Advisory Committee

(Name of the Department)

Date:

APPENDIX - D

(Certificate for draft)

CERTIFICATE

We, the undersigned, members of the Advisory Committee of Mr./Ms. _____ Id. No. _____, a candidate for the degree of _____ (_____) agree that the thesis entitled _____ may be submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree.

_____	_____	_____
(Name)	(Name)	(Name)
Chairperson	Member	Member
Advisory Committee	Advisory Committee	Advisory Committee
Date:	Date:	Date:

APPENDIX - E

CITATIONS

APA citation style (7th or APA latest edition)

Book with Single Author:

Gore, A. (2006). *An inconvenient truth: The planetary emergency of global warming and what we can do about it.* Emmaus, PA: Rodale.

In-text reference: (Gore, 2006)

Book with Two Authors:

Michaels, P. J., & Balling, R. C., Jr. (2000). *The satanic gases: Clearing the air about global warming.* Washington, DC: Cato Institute.

In-text reference: (Michaels & Balling, 2000)

Book with Three or More than Three Authors:

Mention all authors as shown in two authors pattern.

In-text reference: List only the first author's name followed by "et al."

Book with Editor as Author:

Galley. K. E. (Ed.). (2004). *Global climate change and wildlife in North America.* Bethesda, MD: Wildlife Society.

In-text reference: (Galley, 2004)

Brochure or Pamphlet:

New York State Department of Health. (2002). *After a sexual assault.* [Brochure]. Albany, NY: Author.

In-text reference: (New York, 2002)

An Anonymous Book:

Environmental resource handbook. (2001). Millerton, NY: Grey House.

In-text reference: (Environmental Resource Handbook, 2001)

Articles in Reference Books (unsigned and signed):

Greenhouse effect. (2005). *American heritage science dictionary*. Boston, MA: Houghton Mifflin.

Schneider, S. H. (2000). Greenhouse effect. *World book encyclopedia* (Millennium ed. Vol. 8, pp. 382-383). Chicago, IL: World Book.

In-text references: (Greenhouse effect, 2005)
(Schneider, 2000)

Magazine Articles:

Allen, L. (2004, August). Will Tuvalu disappear beneath the sea? Global warming threatens to swamp a small island nation. *Smithsonian, 35*(5), 44-52.

Begley, S., & Murr, A. (2007, July 2). Which of these is not causing global warming? A. Sport utility vehicles; B. Rice fields; C. Increased solar output. *Newsweek, 150*(2), 48-50.

In-text references: (Allen, 2004), (Begley &Murr, 2007)

Newspaper Articles (unsigned and signed):

College official agree to cut greenhouse gases. (2007, June 13). *Albany Times Union*, p. A4.

Landler, M. (2007, June 2). Bush's Greenhouse Gas Plan Throws Europe Off Guard. *New York Times*, p. A7.

In-text references: ("College Officials", 2007)
(Lander, 2007)

Journal Article with Continuous Paging:

Miller-Rushing, A. J., Primack, R. B., Primack, D., & Mukund, S. (2006). Photographs and herbarium specimens as tools to document phonological changes in response to global warming. *American Journal of Botany*, 93, 1667-1674.

In-text reference: (Miller-Rushinget al., 2006).

Journal Article when each issue begins with p.1:

Bogdonoff, S., & Rubin, J. (2007). The regional greenhouse gas initiative: Taking action in Maine. *Environment, 49*(2), 9-16.

In-text reference: (Bogdonoff & Rubin, 2007)

Journal Article from a Library Subscription Service Database with a DOI (digital object identifier)"

Mora, C., & Maya, M. F. (2006). Effect of the rate of temperature increase of the dynamic method on the heat tolerance of fishes. *Journal of Thermal Biology*, 31, 337-341. doi : 10.101b/jtherbio.2006.01.055

In-text reference: (Mora & Maya, 2006)

Pokharel, N. (2014). *Effects of different fertilization and feeding systems on water quality and growth performance in Nile tilapia* (Master thesis, Agriculture and Forestry University, Chitwan, Nepal).

In-text reference: (Pokharel, 2014)

Website:

United States Environment Protection Agency. (2007, May 4). *Climate Change*. Retrieved From the Environment Protection Agency website: http://www.epa.gov/climatechange

In-text reference: (United States Environment, 2007)

Gelspan, R. (2007). *The Heat Is Online*. Lake Oswego, OR: Green House Network. Retrieved form The Heat Is Online Website: httt://www.heatisonline.org

In-text reference: (Gelspan, 2007)

APPENDIX -F

(Format for Abstract)

ABSTRACT

Name: Id. No.:

Semester and year of admission: Degree:

Advisory Committee Chair: Department:

_____ _____

(Name) (Name)

Advisory Committee Chair Student

APPENDIX – G

(Final Thesis Acceptance Form)

The thesis attached herewith, entitled ("title of the thesis in capital letters") prepared and submitted by (full name of the student in capital letters), in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of (name of the degree), is here by accepted.

Sd.
(Name)
Chairperson, Advisory Committee
Date:

Sd.
(Name)
Member, Advisory Committee
Date:

Sd.
(Name)
Member, Advisory Committee
Date:

Accepted as partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of (name of the degree).

Sd.	Sd.
(Name)	(Name)
Chairperson	Dean
Department of ……..	Faculty of …….
Date:	Date:

APPENDIX – H

(Final Dissertation Acceptance Form)

The dissertation attached herewith, entitled ("title of the dissertation in capital letters") prepared and submitted by (full name of the student in capital letters), in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of (name of the degree), is here by accepted.

Sd.	Sd.
(Name)	
	(Name)
Chairperson, Advisory Committee	Member, Advisory Committee
Date:	Date:
Sd.	Sd.
(Name)	(Name)
Member, Advisory Committee	Member, Advisory Committee
Date:	Date:

Accepted as partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of (name of the degree).

Sd.	Sd.
(Name)	(Name)
Dean	Director
Faculty of…….	Post Graduate Program
Agriculture and Forestry University	Agriculture and Forestry University
Date:	Date: